



BUILD BLOCK BRIEF · FALL 2026-27

Foundation · The Karachi File CIVIC LANE

Planning brief session 4 · build from session 8 · 192 students · 41 teams · courses: GBMS323, GCO0326, GHCR313, GHCS324, GHFQ318, GHIP322, GHRW321, GHIS312, GHTP314, GCAP314, GHHS325, GCDD328, GHHE312, GMT312, GCCO437, GRQR811, GRRM671

What your team is building

Fieldwork within Defence, Clifton, Saddar and PECHS. Every project carries a literature chapter, a survey instrument, eight weeks of data, statistical analysis, a constitutional and ethical chapter, and a recommendation to the authority named.

ONE PROJECT, SEVERAL GRADEBOOKS

You submit **one** piece of work, and each course that marks it looks at a different dimension, out of 20. **At most eight courses mark one team file.** A course you take that falls outside those eight sets you a **lens note** instead — an individual piece on the same project from that course's angle, 3,000 words, same rubric, same 20 marks. No student carries more than two: from a third, that course marks your viva out of 30 instead.

YOUR MARKS FROM THIS PROJECT

30 the project — a team mark of 20 from each course that marks your file, plus your own viva of 10, held in class in session 14
30 the mid-term
40 the final
 The three quizzes are practice and carry no marks.

This replaces coursework, not classes.

What each course marks

CODE	COURSE	WHAT THIS COURSE MARKS — 20 MARKS
GBMS323	Business Maths & Stats Zaeem Farooqui	This course marks the evidence: the sampling plan and why it was chosen, the survey instrument, the accuracy of the data entry and cleaning, the descriptive and inferential analysis, the charts, and whether the conclusions drawn are the ones the numbers support. 20 marks, team.
GCO0326	Object Oriented Programming Yahya Ali Rashidi	This course marks the software: the class model behind the data-capture and reporting tool, the correctness of its encapsulation and inheritance, its handling of bad input and file errors, and the readability of the code the team submits. 20 marks, team.
GHCR313	Comparative Religions Dr Ambareen Atiq	This course marks the plural-community chapter of the file: how accurately each community's position is described, whether primary sources and named voices were used, and how carefully difference is handled where the civic problem affects communities unequally. 20 marks, team.



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CODE	COURSE	WHAT THIS COURSE MARKS — 20 MARKS
GHCS324	Communication Skills Eesha Ali	This course marks the spoken half of the file: the interviews used to gather evidence, the eight-minute pitch, its structure, delivery and handling of questions, and the quality of the criticism each student gives to other teams. 20 marks, team.
GHFQ318	Fehm-e-Quran Noman Idress	This course marks the ethical reading in the file: the passages chosen, the accuracy of their translation and reference, and the care with which the obligation they describe is stated and connected to the civic problem the cohort studied. 20 marks, team.
GHIP322	Ideology & Constitution of Pakistan Dr Ambareen Atiq	This course marks the constitutional and civic chapter of the file: which rights, duties and powers the problem actually engages, which tier of government owns it, the accuracy of every citation, and the strength of the argument for action. 20 marks, team.
GHRW321	Academic Reading & Writing Maliha Khaqan	This course marks the written file itself: the thesis and its control, the structure of the argument, the integration and citation of sources, the accuracy of summary and paraphrase, and the quality of the revision between draft and final. 20 marks, team.
GHIS312	Introduction to Social Psychology Maria Tahir	This course marks the social-psychological reading of the file: how group, attitude and influence concepts are applied to the people surveyed, whether the interpretation is warranted by the evidence, and the care taken not to over-read it. 20 marks, team.
GHTP314	Theories of Personalities Syed Shaheer Jawaaid	This course marks the personality chapter: which theories are applied to the people and behaviours in the file, the accuracy of the application, and the honesty about what the evidence cannot show. 20 marks, team.
GCAP314	Applied Physics TEACHER TO BE NAMED	This course marks the physical measurement in the file: what was measured (flow, load, noise, power, distance), the instrument and units, the uncertainty stated, and whether the numbers are used correctly in the argument. 20 marks, team.
GHHS325	History & School of Psychology Aisha Ismail	This course marks the historical chapter: how the problem was understood and dealt with over time, the primary and secondary sources used, and the accuracy and balance of the account. 20 marks, team.



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GCDD328	Digital Logic Design — Lab Haris Yaseen	This course marks any device the team builds or wires to collect evidence — a counter, a sensor, a logger — judged on whether the circuit is documented, tested and gives readings the team can trust. Where the team built no device, this course marks the student's named section alone. 20 marks.
GHHE312	History of English Language Amna Khan	This course marks the language of the record: how the public body and the public describe the problem, the English, Urdu and borrowed terms used on signs, notices and documents, and what that shows about who the message is written for. 20 marks, team.
GMTC312	Theories of Communication Design Dr. Sabir Ahmed	This course marks how the finding is communicated: the charts, maps and one-page summary for the authority, judged against the communication principles taught in the course and on whether a busy official would read them. 20 marks, team.
GCC0437	Computer Organization & Assembly Language — Lab Mariha Fahad	This course marks the low-level tooling behind the evidence: any program, microcontroller routine or data-handling script the team wrote, judged on whether it is documented, tested and reproducible. Where the team wrote none, this course marks the student's named section alone. 20 marks.
GRQR811	Advanced Qualitative Research Muhammad Usman Warriach	This course marks the methodological argument: the fit between theory, question and tradition, the defensibility of access and sampling, the visibility of the coding and memo trail, the handling of consent, withdrawal and reflexivity, and the answer given under cross-examination on method. 20 marks, team.
GRRM671	Research Methodology Rafia Khan	This course marks the whole brief: whether the question is researchable, whether the design answers it, the quality of the instrument and the pilot, the completeness of the consent and data-handling record, the accuracy of the analysis, and the defence of the method under questioning. 20 marks, team.

What to hand in

- **GBMS323 Business Maths & Stats** — By session 12 the team files the survey instrument, the cleaned data set as a spreadsheet, the analysis workbook with every formula visible, and a four-page statistical annex of charts and tables for the Karachi File.



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- **GCOO326 Object Oriented Programming** — By session 12, a working C++ program that records the team's survey responses, validates them, stores them to file and prints the summary tables used in the written report — submitted with source, class diagram and AI declaration.
- **GHCR313 Comparative Religions** — By session 13 a referenced chapter of about 900 words on how the civic problem falls across Karachi's religious communities, with consented interview notes, filed with the team's Karachi File and AI declaration.
- **GHCS324 Communication Skills** — By session 13 the recorded eight-minute cohort pitch and its slide deck, the interview log with consent notes, and AI declaration, submitted with the team's Karachi File.
- **GHFQ318 Fehm-e-Quran** — By session 13 a referenced chapter of about 800 words setting out the passages, their translation and the obligation they place on a reader, filed with the team's Karachi File and AI declaration.
- **GHIP322 Ideology & Constitution of Pakistan** — By session 13 a written constitutional framing chapter of about 1,200 words with a duty-bearer map naming the responsible tier and office, filed with the team's Karachi File and AI declaration.
- **GHRW321 Academic Reading & Writing** — One written file per team — first draft in session 11 for peer review, final submission in session 13 with the reference list, the source log and AI declaration.
- **GHIS312 Introduction to Social Psychology** — By session 12 the team files a social-psychology chapter of four pages inside the Karachi File, tied to the survey evidence, with the concepts used defined and sourced.
- **GHTP314 Theories of Personalities** — By session 12 the team files a personality-theory chapter of three pages inside the Karachi File, applying two named theories to the behaviour observed, with sources.
- **GCAP314 Applied Physics** — By session 12 the team files a measurement annex inside the Karachi File: the quantity measured, the method, the readings with uncertainty, and the calculation that turns them into the claim the file makes.
- **GHHS325 History & School of Psychology** — By session 12 the team files a history chapter of three pages inside the Karachi File, with at least two primary sources and a timeline.
- **GCDD328 Digital Logic Design — Lab** — By Session 12 the circuit diagram, the test log and the raw readings go into the evidence annex.
- **GHHE312 History of English Language** — By Session 12 the team files a two-page language note with the examples photographed or transcribed, nobody identified.
- **GMTC312 Theories of Communication Design** — By Session 12 the team files the visual summary and a short rationale for each design choice.
- **GCCO437 Computer Organization & Assembly Language — Lab** — By Session 12 the source code, test runs and a short readme go into the evidence annex.



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- **GRQR811 Advanced Qualitative Research** — By session 13 the study file: theorised question, methodology chapter draft, approved ethics submission with signed consent forms, anonymised transcripts, coding book and memo trail, and analysis with extracts — plus AI declaration.
- **GRRM671 Research Methodology** — By session 12 the complete research brief is submitted: question, literature review, design, instrument, signed consent forms, anonymised pilot dataset, analysis and findings — with AI declaration attached.

How big the file is

The written file is **3,000 words for every member**, plus or minus ten per cent — 15,000 words for a team of five, 12,000 for four, 9,000 for three — plus the artefacts: the evidence or data log with its instrument, interview notes and consent log, any program with its tests, the pitch deck, the AI declaration and the draft-to-final revision log. In the venture and client lanes the live thing itself is the largest artefact. Each member owns one section of 3,000 words with their name on it, one artefact they built, and one part they can defend alone at viva. A lens note is 3,000 words on the same project. The full format is in "The Build Block File — required format" in the kit.



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Dates

Session 4	28 Sep	Planning brief issued — twenty minutes of class: the brief, the Ideas Book and the format sheet. Teams locked since session 3. Choose the project, design the instrument or find the client, split the sections.
Guest session	Session 4, 5 or 6	A practitioner from outside the university speaks to your school, on whichever of those three sessions the speaker can make. Attendance is compulsory. Each student writes one page on it for their own file; it is not marked.
Session 7	19 Oct	One-page plan uploaded to the portal: the question, the instrument or the client charter, who owns what. Not marked — it is the gate. This week the convener merges the marking courses' requirements into the file's sections, so the team writes one document and not eight. Clients matched to teams.
Session 8	2 Nov	Build starts. Rubric issued, roles confirmed, team charter uploaded. Build-with-AI workshop for venture and client teams.
Session 9	9 Nov	Scope agreed with the convener. Client or subject confirmed. Your school arranges its industrial visit for some point between now and session 12.
Session 11	23 Nov	Draft review, inside a normal class: each course teacher sees the teams in their own section for about ten minutes each — show what exists, not what you plan. The convener samples three files per block.
Session 12	30 Nov	The artefact goes live or reaches its first complete state.
Session 13	7 Dec	Final file uploaded with its AI declaration. Venture teams evidence the first paying customer. Five of the twenty come off for each week the file is late, in every course marking it, and nothing is accepted after the Karachi Review.
Session 14	14-19 Dec	Vivas in class: each course holds its own, team by team, in its session-14 class — about three minutes per student, on your own part as that course sees it.
The Karachi Review	Tue 15 Dec	Your team exhibits at its own table, across the campus, all day. The day opens with a thirty-minute handover of studies to the public bodies who asked for them; press and industry attend. Ten panels — a teacher and an alumnus each — circulate the exhibition and score you at your table, about eight minutes a team. Not marked separately; the panel sheet goes to every course marking the file.
Weekend	—	Weekend cohorts hold all of the above in their Saturday and Sunday slots; the Karachi Review runs on a weekend afternoon.

Rules for this lane



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What counts as done

One documented file on a real problem, built on evidence you gathered yourself, with a recommendation you are prepared to defend.

People

Anyone you interview or survey is told who you are, what the work is for, and that they may decline. Names and identifying details are removed before anything is written up. No photographs of people without their spoken consent.

Honesty

Report what you found, including the parts that do not support your argument. Inventing or padding data is an integrity offence and is treated as one.

Safety

Work in pairs when collecting evidence, in daylight, in public places. No fieldwork in any location your convener has not agreed.

Marks

You are marked on the quality of the evidence and the reasoning, not on whether the problem gets solved.

Using AI

You are expected to use Claude and similar tools — to research, to build, to draft, to model numbers. Three rules. Check everything a tool gives you before you use it, and record the check. Declare what you used in the AI declaration bound into the file, as the HEC *Framework on the Use of Generative AI Tools* (2026) requires. Be able to explain, at the viva, everything your team built. **Work you cannot explain is not credited to you.** Undeclared use, or use to fabricate data, references or results, is academic misconduct. Never put real client, patient or examinee data, or anything identifying a real person, into a tool.

BLOCK CONVENER

PROGRAMME HEAD

DATE ISSUED